

Tobias Treppmann

AI First Builder (Design) — owns the full loop: brief, flow, prototype, ship
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PROFILE

I've designed software for fifteen years, and the work I do best has no handoff in it — brief, flow, prototype, the thing that ships. I prototype in real code against real APIs, and engineering builds production from it. The last year went into AI running in production, not demos, where a wrong answer reaches a real person.

70% / 90%

Brief to shipped

less coordination time, and acceptance at the launch customer I write the brief, design the flow, prototype it in real code, and engineering ships from that code

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design 2025 – Present
Bibel TV (B2C streaming product — iOS, Android, web, connected TV; product managers and product owners in-house) Hamburg + Berlin, Germany

- The whole loop, no handoff in the middle. I write the brief, design the flow, prototype it in real code against real APIs, and check the feature in production.
- AI is how the loop closes. Agentic engineering with Claude Code, introduced here as a design practice, and engineering ships from that code.
- AI support copilot, live in production. Drafts replies in the handbook's wording, with a restricted-topic list in the system prompt and every send decision human.
- AI fundraising system, built solo end to end. Performance analysis, prompt architecture, a prototype, then a production Claude skill shipping into in-app notifications.
- The finish, built into the system. A color-extraction API and config tool of mine, live, driving gradients that hold WCAG contrast in light and dark.
- No in-house design team, so I own UI quality and consistency across iOS, Android, web and connected TV, with nobody to delegate it to. Product managers and product owners build day to day, and an external engineering agency ships from my prototype code across a company boundary.

Head of Platform and Design 2024 – 2025
ChurchDesk (vertical ERP for churches and dioceses — DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- 70% less coordination time, 90% acceptance. Scoped as a standalone add-on, built into the platform instead, so the same build carried room rentals, baptisms and weddings across the whole customer base.
- Designer and product manager at once. Wrote the specs, ran the ticket board, and was the main customer-facing contact.
- A legal deadline met automatically. An EU accessibility law landed on churches whose websites the platform hosts; we shipped the capability that met it, under GDPR plus church data-protection law.
- Product management and design together, one direct report, in a company of roughly 50.

Head of Product Design 2023 – 2024
Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US) Berlin, Germany

- Research at a scale a team cannot read. Claude over thousands of forum posts for sentiment and feature requests, with Dovetail as the shared repository.
- Senior Leadership Team, five direct reports including a design lead. Hired two, promoted two.
- Interim Head of Product, July to October 2023.

Product & UX Strategist 2021 – 2022
Hypoport hub SE (shared services arm of listed Hypoport SE) Berlin / Lübeck, Germany · Remote

- Executive-level mandate in a 100+-person shared-services organization. Partnered directly with the executive team, turning case-by-case support into a standard product catalog.

Director of Design 2016 – 2021
Datameer GmbH (collaborative data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC

- Five years of data-dense interfaces where being wrong has consequences. Pivot tables, column charts, aggregated JSON views and filter logic.
- Functional head, two direct reports, peer among department heads under a VP of Design.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

Design Consultant · *Ninox Software GmbH* · Summer 2025 · freelance · prompt-to-database AI onboarding
Senior Mentor · *CareerFoundry* · 2016 – 2026 · Remote · a decade mentoring and coaching designers
UX Strategy Lead · *Spreadshirt* · 2014 – 2016 · Leipzig, Germany · 200+ people
Earlier · *UX Manager, UX Designer, Web Developer* · 2009 – 2014 · Pennsylvania, USA

EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership
Kairos University, South Dakota, USA
Completed 2026

Theological Studies

Theologisches Seminar Rheinland

2003 – 2007

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

SKILLS

Owning the full loop

Writing the brief · designing the flow · prototyping it in real code · running the ticket board · shipping under ambiguity rather than waiting for clarity · measurable outcomes, and able to say whether the metric moved

Prototyping and engineering proximity

Real-code prototypes against real APIs, web, Android and iOS · engineering adapting prototype code into production across a company boundary · HTML, CSS, TypeScript, SwiftUI, Kotlin, React

Craft, taste and the part that shows

Taste as an editorial layer: visual sensibility and detail decided once, in the system · color-extraction API and config tool, live · a track record in data-dense interfaces

Products where being wrong matters

Human-in-the-loop by design, so the send decision stays human · analytics for top US, Canadian and UK banks and insurers · GDPR plus church data-protection law · German native, English C2